Guidelines for Preschool Education



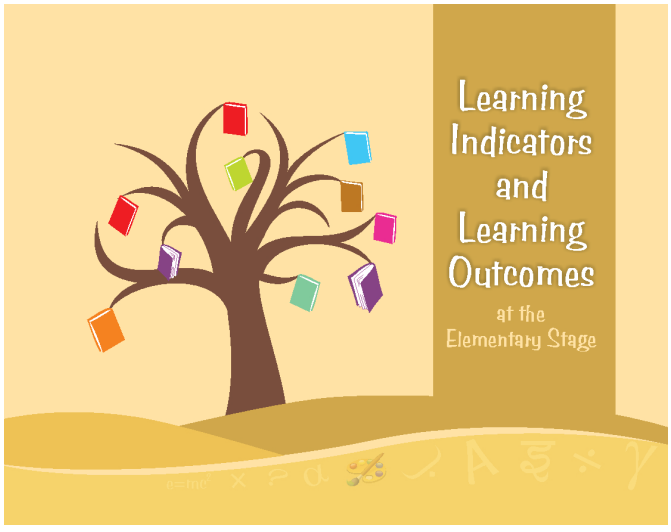




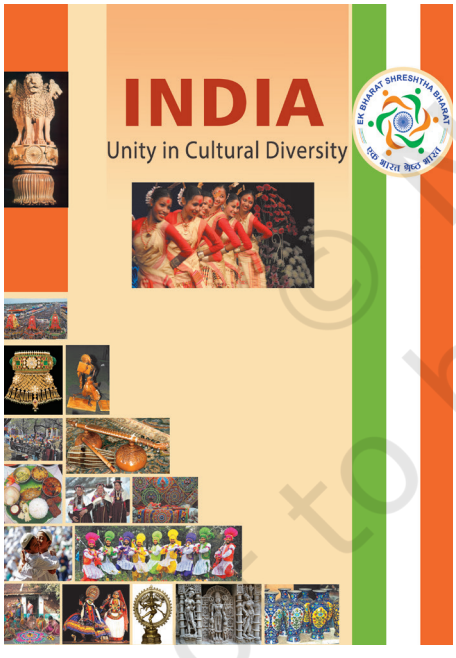




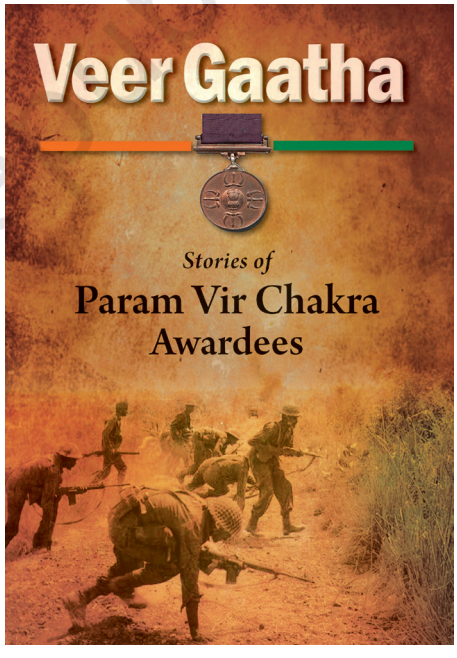
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OFFICES OF THE PUBLICATION DIVISION, NCERT

NCERT Campus
Sri Aurobindo Marg
New Delhi 110 016 **Phone : 011-26562708**

108, 100 Feet Road
Hosdakere Halli Extension
Banashankari III Stage
Bengaluru 560 085 **Phone : 080-26725740**

Navjivan Trust Building
P.O.Navjivan
Ahmedabad 380 014 **Phone : 079-27541446**

CWC Campus
Opp. Dhankal Bus Stop
Panihati
Kolkata 700 114 **Phone : 033-25530454**

CWC Complex
Maligaon
Guwahati 781 021 **Phone : 0361-2674869**

Publication Team

Head, Publication Division : *Anup Kumar Rajput*
Chief Editor : *Shveta Uppal*
Chief Production Officer : *Arun Chitkara*
Chief Business Manager (Incharge) : *Vipin Dewan*
Editor : *Bijnan Sutar*
Production Assistant : *Rajesh Pippal*

Cover and Layout
DTP Cell, DEE

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रमेश पोखरियाल 'निशंक'
Ramesh Pokhriyal 'Nishank'

सत्यमेव जयते

मंत्री
मानव संसाधन विकास
भारत सरकार
MINISTER
HUMAN RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT
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MESSAGE

In the last decade, there has been an accumulation of research evidences from a number of disciplines, that investment in early childhood education significantly improves a child's health, learning ability, future earnings, and life expectancy. Early exposure to learning and development of healthy habits lay down a strong foundation for holistic education and their capacity to contribute meaningfully to the society.

Based on the findings of research, theories of child development and initiatives of the Government, NCERT has developed "The Guidelines for Preschool Education" with inputs from subject experts, academicians, teachers, and teacher educators. The document was placed in the public domain to seek comments and feedback from the stakeholders, SCERTs and state education departments. All relevant suggestions were incorporated in the document.

The Guidelines for Preschool Education are meant for teachers, teacher educators, planners, researchers, administrators and preschool owners of both public and private sector. It suggests essential as well as desirable infrastructure required for running a quality Preschool Programme, qualifications and salary of preschool staff, admission process, records and registers to be maintained, monitoring and supervision and importance of coordination and convergence with parents and community.

This document fulfils a long standing need for providing guidelines to stakeholders for running a quality preschool programme which is holistic, joyful, and aims at maximising individual's potential leading to strong foundations for lifelong learning.

I hope that these guidelines will provide a direction to the preschool teachers, parents, community members, educational planners, and state functionaries in providing quality preschool experiences to children.

(Ramesh Pokhriyal 'Nishank')

सबको शिक्षा, अच्छी शिक्षा।

Room No. 3, 'C' Wing, 3rd Floor, Shastri Bhavan, New Delhi-110 115
Phone : 91-11-23782387, 23782698, Fax : 91-11-23382365
E-mail : minister.hrd@gov.in

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Foreword

Quality early year experiences are crucial for the growth and development of children. Research shows positive impact of quality early learning experiences on school adjustments and learning levels of children in later schooling. During the early years, the child's brain develops at its fastest pace, social and personal habits are formed quickly, and the foundation is laid for the child's subsequent all round development in life.

For enhancing the learning levels of students at the elementary education stage, it is essential that all children are provided preschool experiences of good quality. Providing quality preschool education is one of the goals covered under the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. It is vital to invest in these early years by ensuring an emotionally supportive and stimulating play-based environment for every child, which is not only the right of each child but also a way to provide sound foundation for their life.

It is in this context that NCERT has come out with two documents — *Guidelines for Preschool Education* and *The Preschool Curriculum* to help the teachers, administrators, policy planners and other stakeholders in providing quality preschool education. The guidelines provide the parameters for infrastructure, qualifications and salary of preschool staff, admission process, records and registers to be maintained, monitoring and supervision, and importance of coordination and convergence with community and parents.

The curriculum has been designed for three years of preschool before Class I, which highlights goals, key concepts or skills, pedagogical processes and early learning outcomes for Preschool I, II and III. It also suggests ways of planning a preschool programme, classroom organisation and management, assessment, and building partnership with parents and community.

The documents are result of collective efforts of subject experts, teachers and teacher educators. It is suggestive and can be adopted and adapted by the States, UTs and other stakeholders as per need. The Department of Elementary Education shouldered the responsibility of developing both the documents. The efforts put in by the department are appreciated.

The documents were shared with the SCERTs, State Education Departments and other stakeholders. Their views and suggestions on both the documents were invited. We are thankful to all those who gave their suggestions. We welcome comments and suggestions to bring further improvement in the quality and usability of this document.

Hrushikesh Senapaty
Director
National Council of Educational
Research and Training

New Delhi
October, 2019

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About the Guidelines

The present document is designed for three years of preschool education before Class I for children between the ages of 3–6 years in a progressive manner. The document highlights the parameters for infrastructure, staff and different procedures which need to be followed in delivering quality preschool programme.

The document is divided into eight chapters

Chapter 1: Discusses the definition, vision, aim and objectives of preschool education and also highlights the importance of linkages with primary classes.

Chapter 2: Highlights the essential as well as desirable infrastructure required for running a quality preschool programme like location, play and activity areas, indoor space, facilities for Information and Communication Technology, facilities for staff, drinking water and washing hands, toilet facility, sleeping or rest facility, transport facility, storage space and barrier-free environment.

Chapter 3: Discusses the required preschool staff, their qualifications and salary structure, availability of pre-service training, in-service training and professional development, leadership development for preschool teacher and helper and the roles and responsibilities of preschool staff.

Chapter 4: Highlights the admission process in preschool i.e., the age of admission and the admission procedure.

Chapter 5: Discusses the preschool curriculum—its guiding principles, the duration of preschool programme, the key concepts, pedagogical processes and early learning outcomes, the medium of instruction, assessment, parent involvement and use of technology in preschools.

Chapter 6: Discusses the safety, health, hygiene and nutrition. It discusses the safety precautions to be taken for indoor and outdoor area, identification cards, pick-up and drop-off facility, handling emergencies, child abuse and rights.

Chapter 7: Focuses on records and registers which need to be maintained in preschools like admission record, progress record, visitor's record, teacher's diary, feedback record, attendance register of students and teachers, accounts register, stock register, etc.

Chapter 8: Elaborates the need for coordination and convergence between different departments and agencies for training and capacity building and monitoring and supervision of the programme and its functionaries.

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This document provides a comprehensive picture of quality preschool programme. We hope the present Preschool Guidelines will help the teachers to create an enabling environment in the classroom where they can help children play, learn and be happy. It is hoped that the guidelines will guide the teachers and support them in planning and executing the developmentally appropriate preschool programme.

Suniti Sanwal
Member Coordinator

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Development Team

Advisor

Hrushikesh Senapaty, *Director*, NCERT, New Delhi

Members

Amita Tandon, *Advisor* and *Consultant*, ECCE
Asha Singh, Retd. *Professor*, Lady Irwin College, New Delhi
G.C. Upadhyaya, Retd. *Associate Professor*, NCERT, New Delhi
Padma Yadav, *Professor*, DEE, NCERT, New Delhi
Reetu Chandra, *Assistant Professor*, DEE, NCERT, New Delhi
Rekha Sharma Sen, *Professor*, IGNOU, New Delhi
Romila Soni, *Assistant Professor*, DEE, NCERT, New Delhi
Venita Kaul, *Professor Emeritus*, Ambedkar University, New Delhi

Member Coordinator

Suniti Sanwal, *Professor* and *Head*, DEE, NCERT, New Delhi

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Acronyms

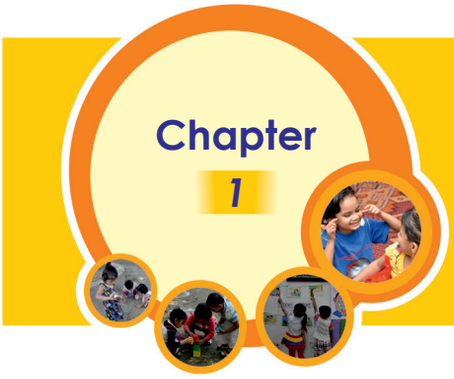
AWTC	*Anganwadi* Training Centres
BRC	Block Resource Centre
CCTV	Closed Circuit Television
CDPO	Child Development Project Officer
CRC	Cluster Resource Centre
CWD	Children With Disability
DEO	District Education Officer
D.El.Ed.	Diploma in Elementary Education
DIET	District Institute of Education and Training
DPSE	Diploma in Preschool Education
ECD	Early Childhood Development
ECE	Early Childhood Education
ECCE	Early Childhood Care and Education
GCERT	Gujarat Council of Educational Research and Training
ICDS	Integrated Child Development Services
ICT	Information and Communication Technology
IGNOU	Indira Gandhi National Open University
MHRD	Ministry of Human Resource Development
MLTC	Middle Level Training Centre
MWCD	Ministry of Women and Child Development
NCERT	National Council of Educational Research and Training
NCTE	National Council for Teacher Education
NERIE	North Eastern Regional Institute of Education
NIOS	National Institute of Open Schooling
NIPCCD	National Institute of Public Cooperation and Child Development
NGO	Non Governmental Organisation
NSQF	National Skills Qualification Framework
PTM	Parent Teacher Meeting

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POCSO	Protection of Children from Sexual Offences
RPL	Recognition of Prior Learning
RTE	Right to Education
SCERT	State Council of Educational Research and Training
SIE	State Institute of Education
SMC	School Management Committee
TLM	Teaching-learning Material
UT	Union Territories

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Chapter 1

Introduction

The first eight years of a child's life are formative years, which are recognised as critical time for brain growth and development. Recent neuroscience researches confirm the importance of early years in a child's life. It shows that within the span of the early childhood years, there are certain 'critical periods' for the development of significant cognitive, linguistic, social and psychomotor competencies, which are known to contribute to success in later life. This stage is also important as a foundation for the inculcation of social values and personal habits. At this stage, children are curious and enchanted about the people and the world around them—its colours, shapes, sounds, sizes and forms. This ability to connect with others and to share feelings with them lays a special basis for learning. Children's ability to experience the world gets richer and more differentiated over the years. In the exploration of their environment, children are involved in observation, questioning, discussion, prediction, analysis, exploration, investigation and experimentation. In this process, they construct, modify and develop broad based concepts and ideas. Children need to be given ample opportunities to observe, explore and investigate so that they can develop an understanding of their immediate and wider environment.

Young children learn best in an emotionally supportive and enabling environment where responsive teachers help to develop safe and secure relationship with children. Children feel free to explore, express, learn and build their confidence in such an atmosphere. Moreover, it promotes equity, improves school attendance, offers a high pay-off in human capital, and also benefits communities and societies at large. Therefore, it is crucial to invest in these early years through ensuring an enabling environment for every child, which is not only their right but also a way to ensure a sound foundation for life. This can be done by ensuring better provisions for quality preschool for young children.

The Government of India has made many efforts to ensure preschool education provisions to improve its quality in terms of providing health and care facilities, infrastructure, curriculum, teacher training, and enhancing teaching-learning process (*National Education Policy*, 1986; *National Curriculum Framework*, 2005; *National ECCE Policy*, 2013; *National ECCE Curriculum Framework*, 2013 and *Quality Standards for ECCE*, 2013). According to the recent surveys, the accessibility to the provisions for 3 to 8 years old children, i.e., preschool and early primary education (Class I and II) has increased in the country. With the implementation of the Right to Education Act, 2009 all children are now expected to come into school at the age of 6 years. The research indicates that a very large number of children come into primary school with inadequate school preparedness, and they tend to continue with low learning levels and higher probability of dropping out in

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the early primary classes. There is also a lack of national level standard pattern of preschool programme that is flexible enough to be contextualised and adapted by the implementers.

There is a need for children to be provided with developmentally appropriate early learning opportunities at preschool which, in turn, helps to promote their school readiness and ensure a smooth and seamless transition into formal learning. In this context, a need was felt to develop guidelines for effective implementation of a quality preschool programme.

1.1 Whom is this Document For?

This document is meant for teachers, teacher-educators, planners, researchers, administrators and preschool owners of both public and private sector. These guidelines inform about required physical infrastructure, teacher-pupil ratio, staff qualifications, salary and their roles and responsibilities. It highlights the admission process, safety, health, hygiene and nutrition, as well as maintains records and registers. It gives an overview of the curriculum and focuses on the need for coordination and convergence.

- This document envisages three years of preschool education before Class I.
- The age of entry into the preschool is recommended on completion of three years. The states may fix the age as per their prescribed age of entry to Class I.
- This guideline does not address children below three years.
- It addresses the educational needs of children between 3–6 years.

1.2 Definition of Preschool Education

Preschool education is the education imparted to children in 3–6 years age group. It is the first stage of organised education. Preschool education is also known as pre-primary education. It is provided in any of the settings such as *anganwadis*, nursery schools, preschools, preparatory schools, kindergartens, montessori schools and pre-primary sections located in government and private schools.

1.3 Vision of Preschool Education

Preschool education envisions promoting access to universal, equitable, joyful, inclusive and contextualised learning opportunities for ensuring holistic development of all children between 3–6 years of age. These can be ensured by involving parents and teachers in providing an emotionally supportive, culturally rooted, child-oriented, and stimulating learning environment. It aims at maximising individual potential by creating strong foundation for lifelong learning through play and developmentally appropriate practices. It also intends to develop healthy attitude, good values, skills of critical thinking, collaboration, communication, creativity, technology literacy, and socio-emotional development and ensures smooth transition from preschool to primary school, thus, enabling children for a productive and satisfying life in future.

1.4 Aims of Preschool Education

The overarching aims of preschool education are:

- providing strong foundations for all round development and life-long learning.
- preparing the child for school.

1.5 Objectives of Preschool Education

- To ensure a child-friendly environment where each child is valued, and respected, feels safe, and secure and develops a positive self-concept.
- To enable a sound foundation for good health, well-being, nutrition, healthy habits and hygiene.
- To enable children become effective communicators and foster both receptive and expressive language.
- To help children become involved learners, think critically, be creative,

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collaborative, communicative and connect with their immediate environment.

- To enable a smooth transition of children from preschool to primary school.
- To work as partners with parents and community to enable each child flourish.

1.6 Existing Models of Preschools

There are various kinds of programmes available for children in the country. The existing models include *anganwadies*, private preschools (stand alone), government and private schools having preschool sections and *anganwadies* located in government primary schools.

- Locating the preschools in the same campus or in close proximity to the primary schools.
- The physical set-up of Class I and II should be planned in the same manner as in preschools having activity corners, print-rich environment and display of children's work.
- Seating arrangement should be such which allows children to interact and share experiences, develop problem-solving skills, coping skills, follow rules and gain a sense of social and emotional well-being.
- Making use of similar pedagogical processes in teaching and learning as well as maintaining familiarity

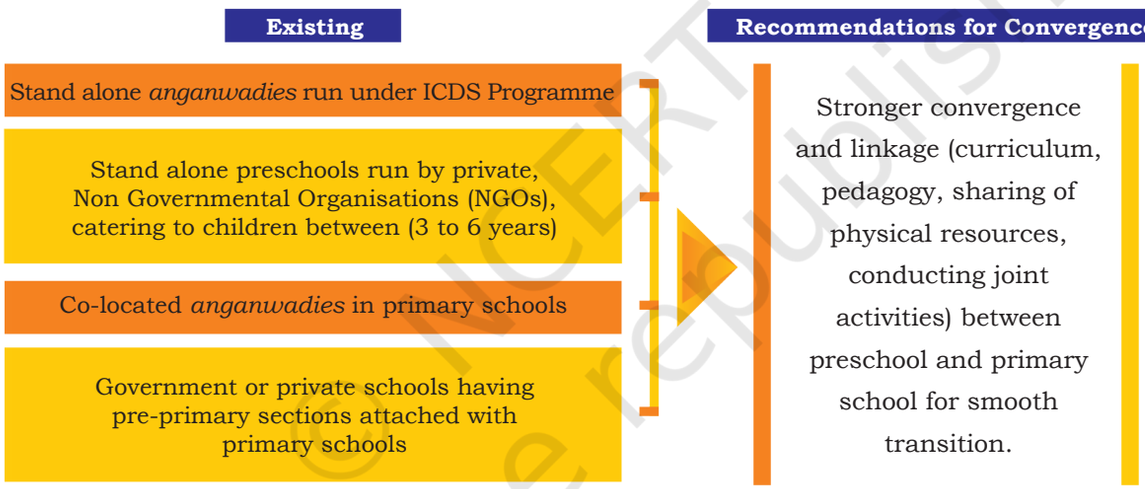


Fig. 1.1: Existing models of preschools

1.7 Developing Linkages with Primary Grades

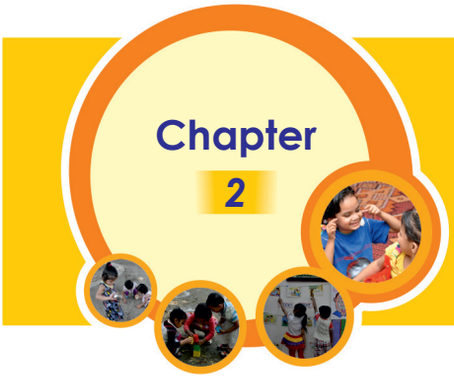
Preschools and early primary grades constitute the foundational stage for education, for school and for life. Children between 3–8 years age group show developmental continuities. Therefore, there is a need to have upward linkages in curriculum, pedagogy and the learning outcomes. Therefore, three areas of linkage have been identified—settings, systems and individuals. Such linkage can be ensured by:

in the physical and socio-emotional environment of the school (in terms of infrastructure, resources, teacher-child interaction, etc.).

- The teachers of preschool and primary school should have continuous interaction for sharing the activities being conducted and level of children's progress through their portfolio.
- There is a need to share resources and to conduct joint activities like annual day, sports day, celebration of ECCE day, festivals, *bal mela*, tree plantation day with the primary grades, etc.

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Chapter 2

Physical Infrastructure

Preschool is essentially a play and activity based programme for which adequate infrastructure including indoor and outdoor space is a prerequisite. Adequate infrastructure would imply not only sufficient space for free movement but also appropriate in terms of safety, sanitation, light, ventilation and transportation. Given below are the essential as well as desirable physical infrastructure for running a quality preschool programme.

2.1 Location

Essential

The building in which the preschool is located should be at a site that is:

- easily accessible to the children.
- away from heavy traffic, ponds, wells, ditches, *nallahs*, heaps of garbage, cattle shed or animal shelter, slush, stagnant water and uncovered drains.
- surrounded with a boundary wall or a fence with a gate to mark the safe area.

Desirable

- The preschool may be located on the ground floor.
- There may be a direct approach to road for easy transport and delivery of supplies.
- The preschool may preferably be in the same premises of the primary school or it should be close to or adjacent to a primary school.
- The immediate surroundings of the preschool may have plenty of natural resources which can be used as educative material.

2.2 Play and Activity Areas (Outdoor and Indoor Space)

Outdoor space

Essential

- Outdoor play area must be large enough, i.e., minimum 300/450 (15×20/30) square metres per 25 children in the preschool to play and run around safely.
- The playground and materials should be adapted for Children With Disabilities (CWDs).

Desirable

- A sand pit may be created under some shaded and fenced place like under a tree.
- A water play area can be created or a water tub can be used in both indoor as well as outdoor areas.



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Indoor space

Essential

- The standard floor area of a preschool classroom should be of minimum 35 (5×7) square metres to accommodate a maximum of 25 children. It should be well ventilated and well lit. It should have proper roofing, windows, doors and flooring with provision of mats wherever necessary.
- The size of chairs and tables should be suitable for preschool children.
- Stackable child-friendly furniture that can be easily moved according to the play activities should be used to ensure flexible classroom organisation.



- There should be provision for a blackboard according to the height of the children.
- A *durry* or carpet should be provided for circle time and large group activities.
- Low open shelves or open big baskets to store the play and learning material must be provided. These may be labeled with pictures and print to enhance print awareness in young children.
- There must be a provision of electricity for light fittings, fans and other electrical equipment.
- There should be regular provision and supply of stationery, such as, crayons, variety of papers, sketch pens, coloured chalks, etc.

Activity areas should be created in the classrooms. If there is constraint of space, these can be designed on a rotational or temporary basis as per the theme and needs of the children. Care should be taken to design activity areas so that they are visible from every part of the room, this will enable a teacher to observe all the children. The following are the suggestive activity areas which should be equipped with adequate material for children:

- **Book area:** This area should have a variety of age appropriate children's magazines, information books, picture books, story books, large books, local folk-tales, thematic books, comics, slates, chalks, etc.
- **Doll's area and dramatic play area:** The materials to be kept here can be various kinds of dolls, doll-sized furniture and clothes, doll-sized cooking utensils (pots, dishes, spoons, etc.), pretend food (vegetables or fruits made of clay), dress-up clothes (scarf, cap, stole, jacket, small *sari*, long pieces of cloth, etc.), combs, mirrors, walking sticks, old spectacles, non-functional telephones or cameras, a briefcase and a lunch box, etc.



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- **Discovery area:** It should be equipped with materials like magnifying glasses, shells, plants, seeds, magnets, iron objects, weighing scales and weights, measuring tapes or any other locally available materials.
- **Block building area:** This area should have variety of blocks of different colours, shapes and sizes, such as, hollow blocks, interlocking blocks, foam blocks, wooden blocks, etc.
- **Manipulative:** This area should have manipulative materials, such as, puzzles, matching cards, lacing cards, seeds, seriated shapes, inset boards, shells, material for sorting, strings and beads, small toys, such as, cars, trucks, animals, toy figures, take apart toys, number rods, abacus, and other objects from the environment, such as, leaves, stones, pebbles, twigs, flowers, etc.



- **Art area:** The materials in this area should have different types of papers (lined, unlined), crayons, pencils, washable markers, slates, coloured chalks, pieces of fabric, paints, brushes, tape, play dough or clay, rolling pins, boards, stencils, old newspapers, magazines, ice-cream sticks and other locally available materials.



- **Music and movement area:** The music area may be equipped with *daphli*, bells, bowls, flutes, tambourines, string instruments, rattles, utensils of different types or metals, local musical instruments, music system and a variety of DVDs of songs, poems and rhymes. This area may have material such as ribbons or scarves for the children to use as props to promote creative movement.

Desirable

- There should be a library in each preschool having appropriate resource material and educational audio-visual aids for teachers and children.

Note: For details of safety measures in indoor and outdoor areas, refer to Chapter 6.

2.3 Facilities for Information and Communication Technology (ICT)

Desirable

- Television, music system, LCD projector with screen, computer, smart board or interactive white boards, digital camera, DVDs or CDs, etc., can be used in the preschool programme.
- ICT can be used to provide combined experiences to preschool and early primary grade children, e.g., screening of story, music and dance experience, etc.
- Teachers may use available e-resources like interactive websites, educational

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apps, educational video sites, digital storytelling and e-books.

- Teachers may also join online organisations where they can gather and organise the most commonly used websites for the education of preschoolers on computer desktops and mobile phones.

2.4 Facilities for the Staff

- A separate area or room must be provided for the preschool staff to keep their personal belongings (teacher diary, anecdotal records, etc.) to plan and discuss activities, do administrative work and hold meeting with parents.
- Tables, chairs, benches and small almirahs should be available in the room.
- A toilet for the staff should also be provided separately.

2.5 Facility for Drinking Water and Washing Hands

- Facility for safe drinking water and washing hands should be provided.
- In case water purifiers are being used in the preschool, it should be serviced regularly and refilled.
- Provision should be made for washing glasses and tumblers after use.

2.6 Toilet Facility

- There should be child-friendly toilets, separate for boys and girls and for children with disabilities.
- Toilets should be safe, functional and have regular water supply.
- Soap for washing hands and a clean towel should be made available.
- Bathroom fixtures and sinks should be according to the height of children.
- There should be an arrangement for regular cleaning of the toilets.

2.7 Sleeping or Rest Facility

- If the duration of the preschool is more than four hours in order to coincide with the timings of the primary schools, arrangements should be made for taking a nap or rest for all children.
- Provision for clean mattress with a sheet should be made.

2.8 Transport Facility

The States and UTs must develop their own guidelines for providing safe transport facilities to children as per their need.

2.9 Storage Space

Essential

Storage space (both for teacher and children) should be provided for storing materials like paper, crayons, sketch pens, charts, teaching aids, folders and portfolios, etc.

Desirable

Each child should be provided a low shelf, locker, or cubbyhole for personal use. These may be at children's height i.e., within easy reach of the child.



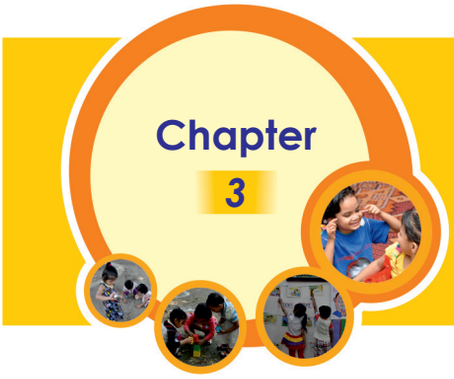
2.10 Barrier-free Environment

To include Children With Disabilities, the following facilities must be ensured:

- The classroom layout should facilitate free movement for all children in the class.
- Ramp should be built with handrails.
- Play equipment and materials, furniture and other facilities in all the activity areas.
- Toilets with appropriate accessories and modifications.

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Chapter 3

The Preschool Staff

A preschool should have dedicated staff, who can collaborate to create a cohesive and joyful learning environment for children in preschool centres. The preschool staff, especially teachers provide opportunity to children for holistic development inside and outside the classroom. Apart from the teachers, administrators and helpers are equally important for the successful functioning of preschool programme. They should be carefully selected on the basis of their experience, education, and dedication to the preschool education. The qualification of each staff member, their role in the learning of children and proper functioning of preschool centres, ideal teacher-children ratio, their salary structure, recruitment and service conditions, as well as their professional development, is discussed below:

3.1 Suggested Staff, Qualification and Salary Structure

Qualification and Salary	Essential Staff	Desirable Staff
• As per government norms • Salary as per norms	**Administrator** (Principal/Headmaster of the Primary School)	Supervisor or Incharge where there are more than four sections for preschool programme. The senior most teacher should be designated as incharge of the preschool programme
• Class XII pass with two years Diploma in Preschool Education recognised by NCTE • Salary as per norms for primary school teacher	**Teacher** One for 20 children with a helper for 3–4 years old. One teacher for 25 children with a helper for 4–6 years old.	**Assistant Teacher** Where there are more than 25 children in a class, an assistant teacher is recommended
• Class X pass, minimum 18 years of age, must have induction training in preschool education	**Helper** One for 20–25 children up to 3–6 years old.	
	Security Guard	**Parent Volunteers** Local craftsmen, artisans willing to work with children; art and craft instructors, music instructors
• Salary as per State norms for semi-skilled persons	**Support Staff** Cook, accounts person, peon and gardener	

Note: Police verification should be done for all the preschool staff.

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3.2 The Preschool Teacher

Preschool years are very crucial for the holistic development of children between the age of 3–6 years and for laying the foundation for lifelong learning. A child at this stage particularly needs a teacher who is qualified and well trained, with a passion for teaching young children, enjoys interacting and playing with them, encourages questions and promotes sharing. The preschool teacher is therefore, required to plan developmentally appropriate high quality preschool education programmes, by designing and providing a suitable classroom environment, child-friendly materials, age-appropriate play activities and guide children's learning through meaningful interactions and scaffolding. She should demonstrate necessary sensitivity and understanding towards young children's developmental needs as also diversity of childhood experiences knowledge and skills. Accordingly, she should plan opportunities and experiences for them that are contextually relevant and would contribute to their optimal development.

It is, therefore, imperative that the preschool teachers have suitable academic qualifications, are professionally trained, periodically mentored and supported and incentivised with a salary at par with that of primary teachers and have a suitable career trajectory.

Since preschool education is an unregulated sector, with ICDS and private schools being the major providers, there is likely to be a large number of untrained teachers or *anganwadi* workers transacting preschool education in the system. With preschool education being considered an integral part of school education now, it is important for the States to create a cadre of preschool teachers similar to primary teachers and expand preservice and in-service teacher development facilities, across the states to ensure availability of professionally trained teachers for this stage of education.

Pre-service training

The National Council for Teacher Education (NCTE), which is a statutory body for regulation of quality of Pre-service Teacher Education, has prescribed minimum qualifications for Preschool Teachers—Class XII pass with a two year Diploma in Preschool Education. States should promote access to this Teacher Education Programme by instituting it in SCERT or District Institute of Education and Training (DIET) and training faculty while also encouraging private institutions, as and when required to expand the availability of professionally trained teachers.

In-service training and professional development

In-service training and other professional development opportunities need to be designed and provided for the preschool teachers as these provide space for teachers to share, make networks, and remain updated in the field. Professional development should be an ongoing process, which will prepare teachers to develop and expand upon their skills and knowledge.

For untrained teachers and *anganwadi* workers already in service, opportunities may be provided for upgrading the qualifications of existing staff by providing vertical skill development programmes under National Skills Qualifications Framework (NSQF) with a provision for Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) and credit accumulation and provision of flexibility with multi-entry and multi-exit options leading up to the desired certification. These programmes could be offered through face-to-face mode or distance and blended modes. Salary structure may be adapted to accommodate this flexibility.

In-service (ongoing) education and training can be conducted 'on the job' or can be provided by an external source, such

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as training institutes or colleges. It can be provided through workshops, conferences, subject training, field-based consultation training, supervised practices and most importantly through on-site mentoring. Institutions including universities, SCERTs and DIETS, should be supported and encouraged to provide specialised training programmes in preschool education which may be in the mode of: (i) contact programmes, (ii) through open and distance mode, or (iii) blended mode (mix of contact and distance mode). It is suggested that the training programmes should have the component of supervised internship in a preschool or *anganwadi*.

important role in supporting professional development. Staff quality is maintained by leadership that motivates and encourages working as a team, information sharing and professional staff development. Therefore, it is very important to orient all the key functionaries involved in the programme about the importance of early years, the importance of play and activity based pedagogy and their role in ensuring quality.

There are certain interim measures taken by the various States or UTs and organisations for professional development of the preschool staff. Some of these measures are given as exemplars.

Exemplar Interim Measures

S. No.	Name of the Organisation	Programme Detail
1.	NERIE, Shillong, NCERT	Three months Certificate Course in ECE
2.	Government of Sikkim	Include three months component of ECCE in D.El.Ed. Course
3.	SCERT, Nagaland	Conduct two years Diploma in Preschool Education (DPSE) approved by the NCTE
4.	GCERT, Gujarat	Two months Online Certificate Course for Preschool Education
5.	SIE, Puducherry	Conduct ECCE Courses as per NIOS. After the course, the students get LDC scale and become permanent teacher.
6.	IGNOU	One year Diploma in Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE) through distance mode
7.	NIOS	One year vocational course in ECCE
8.	Azim Premji Foundation	*In-service Capacity Development of Anganwadi Teachers*: It includes in-service teacher training of *Anganwadi* workers and engagement with them to enable them to transform *Anganwadi* centres into learning centres for holistic development of children.
9.	Mobile Creches	Comprehensive teacher training programme for ECD including all components of child care, i.e., health, nutrition, safety and education.

Leadership development and orientation programme for key functionaries

Leadership of managerial staff like District Education Officers (DEOs), Headmaster or Headmistress of Primary Schools, Child Development Project Officers (CDPOs), Supervisors and others play an

Helper

The preschool teacher needs a helper to transact the programme effectively. Since, the helper is regularly interacting with young children, she also requires skills and knowledge about the basics of child development, engage with young children,

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maintain hygiene and cleanliness of children as well as the classroom, help in serving food and help teacher in different activities. It is important that she is well trained for her roles and responsibilities. The helper should assist the teacher in the day-to-day implementation of the preschool curriculum, she should also be able to conduct some of the activities with children, as and when the need arises. Provision for career upgradation should also be provided for the helpers after taking into account their qualification and experience in the field.

3.3 Roles and Responsibilities of Preschool Staff

Administrative				
Head of the Preschool	**Supervisor or Incharge**	**Teacher**	**Assistant Teacher**	**Helper**
• Manage day-to-day operations of the preschool education programme. • Coordinate with co-located *anganwadi* workers, supervisors and other functionaries for convergence. • Supervise the implementation of ECCE preschool programme.	• Conduct routine inspection of centre's facilities for health, nutrition, safety, fire and occupancy compliance and take necessary corrective action. • Supervise the preschool programme along with regular teaching or without regular teaching responsibilities.	• Assist the Headmasters Headmistress or Supervisor in purchasing of materials. • Training the Assistant Teacher to transact the curriculum in her absence. • Training helper to support in the implementation of preschool programme.	• Supervising the work of a helper. • Supporting teacher in planning and implementing age-appropriate activities.	
• Organise meetings with the staff and maintain record of the meetings whenever required. • Supervise and guide all teachers and other staff members.	• Conduct periodic observations to evaluate job performance of assigned staff, maintain appropriate documentation, and meet timelines. • Conduct regular staff meetings for group.	• Supporting supervisor and head of the preschool. • Supervising the work of a helper.		
Programme and Curriculum Implementation				
• Coordinate and support for effective curriculum transaction.	• Provide guidance, hand-holding and technical assistance to	• Become familiar with the early learning outcomes and developmental	• Prepare teaching-learning materials.	• Escort the children from the time of arrival, departure,

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• Supervise and participate in the conduct of training and orientation programmes, workshops and other professional development activities for teachers.	other staff (i.e., assistant teachers). • Plan, organise and oversee implementation of a curriculum that is age and developmentally appropriate. • Ensure completion of growth monitoring, health screening of all children and proper maintenance of records. • Ensure that balanced snacks and meals are provided to children. • Ensure children's safety and well-being at all times.	goals and accordingly plan activities. • Prepare monthly or weekly lesson plans and daily schedules to ensure holistic development of all children keeping in mind diversity and special needs of children. • Maintaining student portfolio. • Identify developmental delays, plan and implement specific activities with the support of special educator. • Plan and arrange field trips or nature walks according to the need. • Plan balanced snacks and meals. • Ensure children's safety and well-being at all times. • Observe and assess children's behaviour and performance and make notes. • Communicate observations to children's parents at regular intervals. • Plan lessons that allow for child initiated	• Conduct and assist in organising small group activities as guided by the preschool teacher. • Assist the preschool teacher during structured large group activities such as circle time, whole group storytelling, etc. • Become familiar with the early learning outcomes and developmental goals and accordingly plan activities. • Assist the teacher in developing lesson plans. • Assist the preschool teacher in planning and developing activity areas, display boards and physical set-up of the room. • Assist the teacher during field trips and nature walk. • Identify individual child's strengths and needs, reporting to the preschool teacher and helping the teacher in assessment.	between activities (for example to outdoor areas and toilet). • Preparation of food under the supervision of the teacher and assistant teacher. • Assist the teacher during field trips and nature walk.

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		and teacher-initiated activities. • Taking remedial measures for children absenteeism, if required.	• Maintaining student portfolio. • Engaging with children in the absence of the teacher.	
Support of Parents, Community and Other Stakeholders				
• Coordinate with teachers for supporting children with special needs.	• Act as a one point contact for the preschool and a link between parents, community, teachers and headmaster or headmistress. • Coordinate for administrative queries such as attendance, admission, transport, parent teacher meetings, fees, etc. • Plan and organise orientation for the parents on the philosophy, policies and pedagogical processes of the preschool education and ensure their participation. • Collect suggestions and feedback from the parents.	• Work with the preschool team to strengthen the programme and parental support activities. • Develop a relationship with parents, community and involve them as partners in their child's education. • Communicate and share information of interest with parents and community regularly during parent teacher meetings. • Deliver informational sessions and workshops for parents. • Observe and assess children's performance and provide feedback on children's progress in a sensitive manner.	• Assisting the preschool teacher for maintaining communication with the parents and community and making home visit whenever necessary.	• Interacting with parents when they come to school.

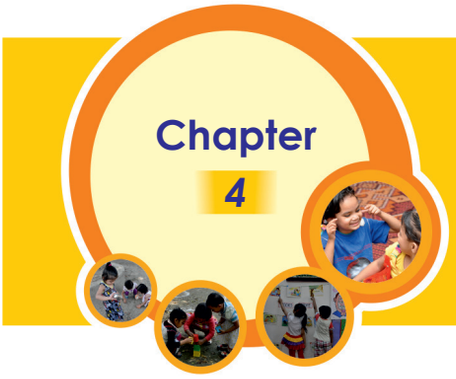
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Classroom Duties				
• Guidance on 21st century skills and techniques to be used in improving preschool programme such as critical thinking, collaboration, working in teams, self-regulation, etc.	• Plan and help in designing the classroom and learning environment of the preschool. • Monitor average daily attendance for each child on a weekly basis. • Ensure variety of materials and resources for children to observe, explore and manipulate in activity areas.	• Maintain a safe, comfortable and emotionally supportive environment by using positive and encouraging words. • Prepare teaching-learning materials for all children. • Observe and interact with children in activity areas. • Ensure transaction of daily schedule as per plan (not to be rigid). • Maintain each child's portfolio. • Handling emergencies and giving first-aid. • Interact with children with love, nurturance and empathy.	• Maintain a safe comfortable and emotionally supportive environment by using positive and encouraging words. • Escort and play with children during outdoor play and ensure their safety. • Interact with children in activity areas. • Take responsibility for daily routines of children like arrival, departure, snack time, checking hygiene, etc. • Handling emergencies and giving first-aid. • Interact with children with love, nurturance and empathy.	• Maintain cleanliness of the class intermittently. • Maintain hygiene of the children—toileting, hand washing, etc. • Help the teacher in preparing class for activities such as setting up materials for the activities. • Preparation of room for rest time, music and movement. • Handling emergencies and giving first aid. • Provide love and nurturance. • Serving of food under the supervision of teacher or assistant teacher. • Support the teacher in organising events. • Repair and remove any play material that poses a threat to children.

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Chapter 4

Admission Process

A child is ready to enter in an organised preschool programme if he/she has completed three years of age in the beginning of an academic year and when the child:

- is able to tackle separation anxiety from family.
- has developed some verbal competence and can communicate basic needs.
- has become toilet trained.

4.1 Age for Admission

Dates of admission may differ from state-to-state according to their respective academic calendar. There is variation in the age of admission to Class I in different States and UTs.

Three years of preschool education has been suggested before Class I, i.e., Preschool I, Preschool II and Preschool III.

Preschool I: This is the entry point for admission to the preschool programme.

Preschool II: This class is the progression of Preschool I.

Preschool III: Children will move to Class I after completing Preschool III.

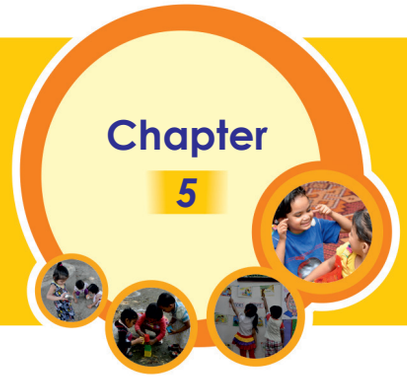
4.2 Admission Procedure

- The admission procedure in preschool programme should not involve any evaluation of children and parents in any form — written or oral.
- No child below the age of 3 years should be admitted to a preschool programme.
- Admission should not be denied to children on the grounds of religion, caste, belief system, race, region, gender, disability and socio-economic status of the family of the child.
- Total transparency should be maintained in the admission procedure.
- Preference should be given to children residing in the neighbourhood.

Follow suggestive strategies for admission of children if number of applicants are more than the seats available:

- First come first serve basis.
- Randomised lottery—Can be manual or computerised. It is important that transparency must be ensured while drawing the lots.
- Quota-based randomised selection should be done based on the state norms of reservation. Depending on the requirement and priorities of the preschool where it is located, e.g., university laboratory, training centre etc., some quota for admission may be fixed in various categories like; (i) employee's ward, (ii) children with disabilities, (iii) single parent, (iv) girl child, etc. Randomised selection in each category may be done.

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Chapter 5

Preschool Curriculum

The curriculum is the sum of everything that happens in the classroom, and its contents can be drawn from the child's natural and social world. The pedagogy and practices to be followed by the teacher must be drawn from the basic early learning principles and should be adapted to the age and learning levels of the child and early learning needs. Children need help in being gradually accustomed to the formal routines of the primary school as well as in learning the basics of literacy (reading and writing) and numeracy (understanding and applying mathematical concepts), and also gaining systematic knowledge of the social and natural environment. Therefore, it is suggested that the early learning principles should be the basis of a preschool curriculum. This would help in the transition to a different stage of education. This will not only prepare them for the next level of learning but also support them throughout their life.

5.1 Duration of Preschool Programme

Essential

- The duration of the preschool education programme should be four hours per day.
- The programme should provide for some rest period during the day. A programme which is of longer duration should provide facilities for nap time also.
- The teacher should come earlier than children and leave after them so that they can make preparations for the next day.

Guiding Principles for Preschool Curriculum

- **Learning is continuous and cumulative.**
- **Evidence from neuroscience proves that early learning matters for later outcomes.**
- **Each child is different and grows, learns and develops at one's own pace.**
- **Play and activity are the primary context of learning and development.**
- **Responsive and supportive interactions with adults are essential to children's learning.**
- **Children learn by being provided the environment for experiential learning.**
- **Interactive teaching enhances learning experiences.**
- **Development and the use of indigenous material enhances learning opportunities.**
- **Responsiveness to the context and appreciation of diversity supports learning.**
- **Mother tongue or home language should be the medium of instruction.**
- **Family involvement contributes to the learning.**

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Desirable

- Children may attend preschool programme for five days in a week, i.e., Monday to Friday; Saturdays may be utilised by the teachers for preschool programme evaluation, planning of the next week's programme, preparation of teaching-learning materials, parental contact, maintaining records, registers and portfolios, etc.

5.2 Curriculum: Key Concepts, Pedagogical Processes and Early Learning Outcomes

The curriculum is holistic in nature and also allows flexibility for contextualisation. It has three broad goals to be addressed, key skills and concepts to be transacted, the pedagogical processes to be followed by the teachers and the early learning outcomes to be achieved by the children at the end of the year.

Learning and development in children is holistic, it advances in the areas of health, cognition, linguistic, personal and social development and well-being simultaneously. Children learn in different ways and at different pace. The curriculum integrates all the domains of development through the following three broad goals:

Goal 1: This goal highlights the different aspects of the socio-emotional and physical-motor development of the children. These aspects include the development of positive self-concept, self-control, social skills, eye-hand coordination, and refinement of gross-motor and fine motor skills through play, creative activities and experiences planned for children. It also provides orientation to health, nutrition, hygiene and safety of the children.

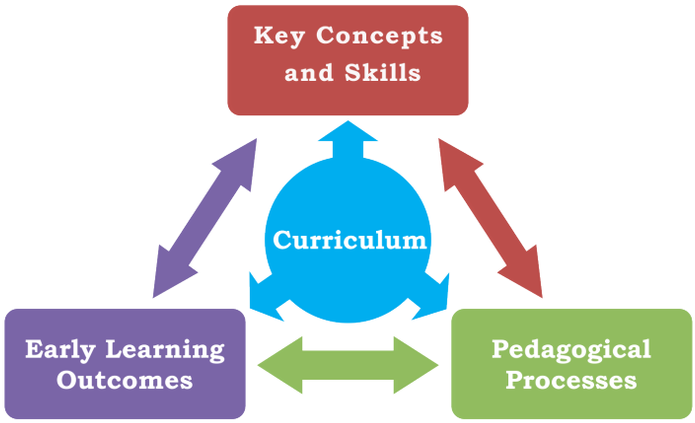
Goal 2: This goal focuses on the development of language and literacy skills which is an integral part of learning in all areas. Children need to be given opportunities to interact with adults and other children, to express themselves creatively and to communicate confidently. When children engage in meaningful literacy activities with purposeful instruction, they develop listening, speaking, reading and writing skills that enable them to be effective communicators.

Goal 3: This goal highlights the cognitive development in children which includes environmental awareness and scientific temper, mathematical thinking and problem-solving. It focuses on how different concepts are formed and skills are acquired by children when they interact with the environment. Opportunities to be curious, expressive, persistent, disciplined, creative, and a good observer are the essence of this goal. In addition, a variety of experiences and activities for developing skills related to problem-solving, critical thinking, and reasoning are also suggested.



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Key concepts and skills: Under each goal, the key concepts or the skills to be transacted are given for the teachers, aiming at holistic development of the children. Teachers are expected to ensure that each concept or skill is addressed in a variety of ways during transaction of the curriculum.

Pedagogical processes: These are the strategies to be used by the teachers to transact the curriculum in such a way that children construct their learning by exploration, investigation, problem-solving and critical thinking thus, achieving the specified early learning outcomes.

Early learning outcomes: These are the expectations for the learning and development of young children. In other words, what children should know and be able to do at the end of each year. Teachers need to align activities, experiences, content and pedagogy and opportunities for play, exploration, discovery, and problem-solving in order to achieve the learning outcomes.

Note: Refer to 'Curriculum for Preschool Education' document for the details.

5.3 Medium of Instruction in Preschools

Language is closely linked to children's identity and emotional security that helps them to freely express their thoughts and feelings. India is a multilingual country where children may come into the preschool with a home language which may be different from the preschool and state language. Research also demonstrates that children who attend preschool programme conducted in their mother tongue face fewer problems of comprehension. Teaching through children's mother tongue and home language, is also internationally recognised as the most appropriate way of working with children in the early years of concept formation. In case, there are more than one language as mother tongue, teachers may allow as many languages as are students in the classroom to be used for expression while gradually exposing the child to school language.

5.4 Assessment

Assessment in preschool should be continuous and comprehensive and should be based on the experiences planned in the curriculum. Assessment should involve observing and documenting the development of the child, i.e., their health and nutritional status, participation and involvement in day-to-day experiences, art work and other products and their behaviour. Assessment is done with the purpose of recognising and encouraging strengths, identifying areas which needs additional support and addressing learning and developmental gaps. Various tools and techniques like anecdotal records, checklist, portfolio and interactions with other children can be used for assessment. Assessment should be non-competitive.

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5.5 Parent Involvement

When there is collaboration between teachers, parents and communities, children do better academically, behaviourally and socially. Teachers should connect with the family to know each child's interest, provide suggestions for activities to be conducted at home by the parents. Sample or photos of child's work at home can be shared by parents with the teacher. Programmes for parent education should also be taken up by the schools. Parents can also be involved in the preschool programme to support as a volunteer in the conduct of activities and field trips.

5.6 Technology in Preschools

Technology has penetrated today into the remotest contexts in India through mobile phones and interactive media and also reached in the hands of the young child. This situation offers both opportunities and challenges for children's learning and development, as children are attracted to technology easily. Although, there is no policy statement in this area in India, research evidence suggests that the use of technology for young child may be useful if it is assistive and serves to extend children's learning and development, such as exposing children to new vocabulary and modes of communication, motor control, conceptual understanding, casual relationships, etc.

It is expected that the strengthening of key cognitive skills included in Goal 3 would also contribute in providing the child a sound foundation for meeting the challenges of negotiating with new technology in the years ahead.

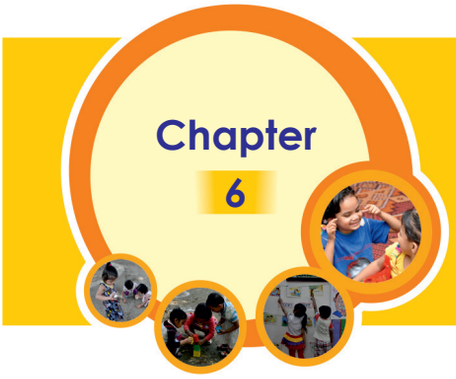
However, the caution is that technology is only beneficial provided, it is mediated by adults and offered in a socially interactive environment. Passive technology, which may replace children's play and exploration, physical activity and social interaction should be discouraged at all levels since it can be counterproductive for children. It can adversely impact their social skills of communication and relationship building, which are of critical importance in the early years.

Internationally, the guidance given to parents is—to follow public health advice on screen time and prohibit the use of non-interactive and passive use of media for children below two years of age and discourage it for children from 2 to 5 years. The key consideration for use of technology for young children should be that it should contribute in extending children's learning and development but not at the cost of opportunities for development of social and communication skills, relationship building, problem-solving and outdoor play.

Appropriate use of Technology	
Do's	**Don'ts**
• Provide ICT as one of the many learning or activity areas within the classroom. • Set guidelines for the usage and upkeep of the devices. • Find apps and games for children that are interactive, age-appropriate and encourage participation from parents or caregivers. • Use technology to enrich the curriculum content and other play activities. • Make ground rules in relation to appropriate behaviour. • Safeguard children from using inappropriate software.	• Screen time should not replace personal interaction. • Do not use play time on computers and phone as a reward for positive behaviour. • Do not sacrifice the basic art material, play dough, books and real objects and hands-on experiences for ICT.

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Chapter 6

Safety, Health, Hygiene and Nutrition

Safety, health, hygiene and nutrition are essential for preschool education. The physical environment of the preschool should be designed in a manner where children feel safe, secure, comfortable, at ease and where they enjoy exploring and learning. It must be seen that children's needs are met. The helpers and other support staff should be trained to supervise and look after the children. There must be adequate staff to maintain hygiene, sanitation, ensure safety, and security of children in the preschool.

6.1 Safety Precautions

Safety of indoor and outdoor area

- The classroom should have adequate space for movement. It must be free from clutter, obstacles, free of slippery floors and rumpled *durries*. The flooring should be even. The play space should ensure the safety of children, i.e., prevent children from running out and getting hurt from grievous injury.
- The furniture should be child-friendly and free from any sharp edges. Nails, screws, and edges must be checked periodically.
- Doors should not have self-locking systems or latches.
- Latches on the door should be beyond the reach of the children.
- There should be a mesh in all the windows. Windows should be secure and there should be no broken glass or fittings.
- Play materials should not have any loose and small parts, which children may swallow by mistake.
- Non-toxic paint and material should be used for play material or equipment.
- Surface of outdoor play area should be free of sharp objects, harmful plants, animals (stray dogs, cows, etc.), discarded materials and equipment.
- The preschool should have a boundary wall with the provision of a gate which can be locked to prevent strangers, stray dogs and other animals.
- During cleaning, daily inspection of indoor and outdoor area must be done to look for sharp objects (needle, pins, branches), poisonous plants and mushrooms, bee or wasp nests and depth of area under swings, etc.
- Outdoor and indoor equipment and play area should be regularly cleaned and maintained.
- Safety check of electrical fittings, fixtures, outdoor and indoor equipment should be done regularly and periodically. Electrical sockets should not be left open and must be installed beyond the reach of children to avoid any accident.
- There should be no open drain, high tension electricity wires, water bodies in the preschool or close to the preschool.
- Items of potential danger or cleaners like flammable liquids, toxic material, soaps and detergent, etc., must be kept in original containers with original

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labels. These should be stored in an area not in use by children and should be away from the kitchen.

- Any arrangement made by the preschool for transporting children should be safe and comfortable. Maintenance of vehicles should be ensured. Number of children allowed in a vehicle should be regulated.

Identity cards

- Every preschool must provide photo identity cards to children and their parents and guardians.
- Whosoever is coming to pick and drop children must carry their identity cards issued by the preschool administration. Security guards must check their identity cards every time they enter and leave the preschool premises.
- Police verification should also be done for all the support staff, drivers and attendants before they are recruited.
- Steps should be taken to make children aware about their safety.

Pick-up and drop-off facility

- There should be a designated place to drop and pick-up the children by the parents. Teachers of respective classes must be present at one side of that area and should themselves, receive or handover children from and to their parents or guardians.
- The place must be restricted with a door or screen or rope. Any outsider and parent should not be allowed to cross the restricted area.
- Parents should provide the photographs, names and identification documents of the persons who should collect or pick the child and nobody else shall be allowed to pick the child from the preschool. The parent or guardian should inform the preschool in case of changes.
- Preferably an attendant (female) should accompany children in the bus or cab from first pick-up point to the last drop-off point.
- There should be specified speed breakers and road signs on either side of the main gate where children will be dropped and picked up from.

Closed circuit television (CCTV)

- CCTV cameras should be installed at the entry and exit gates, at the reception area, waiting area, playground, outside the toilets, and in the corridors.
- CCTV cameras may be installed in all the classrooms, according to need and situation.
- At least one security guard should be assigned the duty to continuously observe the activities on the TV screen.
- The concerned officers should check the CCTV footage regularly.
- Rules and regulations for sharing and period for deletion of CCTV footage should be made.
- It must be ensured that all CCTV cameras are in the working condition.
- Privacy concerns of children should be kept in mind while installing CCTV.

Child abuse and rights

- Children must not be subjected to physical or emotional abuse and corporal punishment, this must not be neglected.
- Children must be sensitised about *Good Touch* and *Bad Touch* in an appropriate manner. The resources available on the web (e-content, videos/illustrations), puppet show, etc., can be used for this purpose.
- All teachers and parents must be trained to identify, understand and respond appropriately in case they observe any sign of child abuse or neglect.
- All the teachers and other staff must be made aware of the POCSO Act (The Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012) and child rights.
- Establish a reporting mechanism for reporting and redressal of any abuse.
- Respecting differences and abstaining from discrimination must be ensured.

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Handling emergencies

Emergency protocol

- Every preschool should have a list of emergency contacts readily available to the staff. It should include telephone numbers of parents and guardians, fire service department, clinic or hospital, ambulance and police department.
- All preschools must have clear written procedures in the event of an emergency. The staff must follow the following procedure in case of any emergency:
  - One staff member should stay with the injured child.
  - One staff member should telephone for an ambulance and child's parents.
  - If possible, transport the child directly to the hospital.
  - At least two to three staff members must stay back to take care of other children.
- All accidents or incidents should be recorded in an accident or incident register with time and nature of the accident or incident and the action taken.
- Accidents that do not require any medical treatment must be reported to the parents or guardians on the day that it occurred.
- The following emergency numbers must be made available on a display board and pasted in each classroom—

Emergency Phone Numbers

- Principal .....
- Doctor .....
- Hospital or Nearest Emergency Centre .....
- Ambulance .....
- Fire Services .....
- Gas Agency .....
- Electrician .....
- Police Station .....
- Child Helpline .....
- Other .....

Note:

(1) Teachers should be trained in handling emergencies.

(2) Refer Annexure II for a sample of maintaining the emergency contact details.

Pest control

There has to be a periodic pest control to prevent dengue, chikungunia, malaria and other insect borne diseases and allergies.

Disaster management

- A diagrammatic building evacuation plan should be displayed at prominent points and near the exits in each preschool. Also, mock fire and earthquake drills or building evacuation may be practised regularly.
- Normal and emergency exits must be well marked with approved 'EXIT' signs. Exit points and routes should also be kept free from obstacles.

Fire safety

There must be fire safety equipment installed, such as, fire extinguishers and adequate supply of water and sand at appropriate places.

Telephone

Telephones must be available at the nearest location to the class to avoid chaos in case mobile phone signals are not working.

Availability of first-aid kit

First-aid kit(s) must be updated regularly and kept in one designated place that should be readily accessible to the staff, but kept out of reach of the children. Given below are some of the important items of the kit, useful in an emergency:

- bandages
- sticking plaster
- sterilised surgical cotton
- gauze
- thermometer
- scissors
- pincers
- antiseptic ointment

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- potassium permanganate
- gentian violet

6.2 Health, Hygiene and Nutrition

Health and immunisation

- Medical check-up of children should be done atleast twice in a year and follow-up and referral services should be provided whenever and wherever necessary.
- The immunisation record of all children must be maintained.
- Growth monitoring should be done quarterly and record of height, and weight of children should be maintained.

Hygiene practices

- Children should be cleaned immediately after they spoil their clothes or urinate in the classroom. In case, they vomit in the classroom; their clothes need to be changed immediately. Since, running nose is very common in children of this age, use of handkerchief must be encouraged.
- A soap or liquid handwash and towel for drying hands should be provided. Appropriate hand washing techniques may be used by the adults and demonstrated to the children regularly.
- Both indoor and outdoor environments must be clean. Big dustbins with lids in each class and in the outdoor area should be provided.
- The helper should accompany 3–4 years old to the washroom.

Supplementary nutrition

Essential

- There should be daily provision of balanced supplementary nutrition for children.
- The eating area must be clean and hygienic.

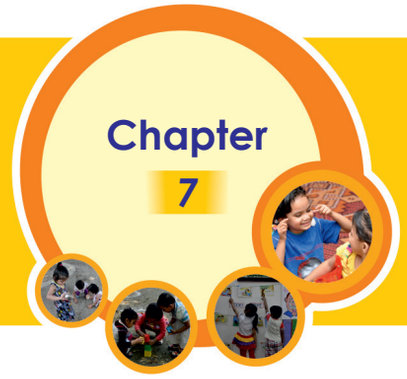
Desirable

- There has to be a separate kitchen for cooking nutritionally balanced meals (if nutrition is provided by the preschool centre).
- A mid-morning snack time (fruit time) should be planned for children.

Note: Teachers must regularly interact with parents to make them aware about the safety, health, hygiene and nutrition of their children.

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Chapter 7

Records, Registers and Preschool Calendar

For efficient management of preschool programme, there is a need for maintaining systematic records and registers. These should be simple in format to facilitate their maintenance. The filling of records and registers should not be so cumbersome as to be done at the cost of actual implementation of the programme. Given below are some essential records and registers, which each preschool centre must keep and maintain regularly.

7.1 Records

Admission records

Admission records help teachers to know about each child's family background, home environment, health status, needs and abilities, etc., in order to stimulate the child to achieve one's growth and development. It includes the following:

Admission and Registration forms

An admission form is given to the parents when they make their first contact with the preschool for registration of the child. It needs to be bilingual (local or regional language and English) for parents to read comfortably and provide information. The preschool office or the teacher should record the date of registration, admission number and roll number, and contact details of each child at the time of registration.

Health record of the child

The health record of each child must include the child's immunisation details, allergies (if any), ongoing medicines, etc. A copy of medical history of the child suffering from any disease must be kept for record and reference.

Progress records

Progress report is a record of the progress of child in various developmental activities of preschool at a given period, based on children's work in preschool or portfolio and teacher's observations. It should be shared with parents regularly.

Portfolio

It is a collection of children's work that demonstrates the achievements of children. It contains name, personal details, noting of interesting discussions held with the child, photographs, artwork, drawing and writing samples; photographs of models made by the child, child at play, participation of the child in role-play, etc.

The progress records can be analysed to see whether the child is developing as per the age. Accordingly, the teacher can modify techniques while working with a particular child and if required, can provide special help and support.

Teacher's diary

Teachers need to maintain a diary having a detailed daily plan of activities. She should plan how she intends to integrate play and activities, what are the materials required, what kind of interactions are to be planned for curriculum transactions. At the end of each day, they should reflect on their

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teaching-learning processes like, 'Was the child able to achieve the objectives or not? Were children able to participate as planned? Was the time sufficient? Were any difficulties faced?', etc., and modify the future activities or plans accordingly.

Visitor's record

Record of each visitor should be maintained in a visitor's register placed at the entry gate of the preschool. Fields to be recorded in the register should include; (i) name of the visitor, (ii) time of entry and exit, (iii) address, (iv) phone number, (v) purpose and (vi) name of the person to be visited.

Feedback record

A register should be maintained to record the feedback, observations or recommendations of the visiting officials, guests, researchers and parents. Their feedback or experience about preschool should be recorded in the register as this may be very helpful for improving the working of the preschool.

Miscellaneous record

Preschools may have miscellaneous records to record the day-to-day information or details such as PTM record, telephone numbers of people whom they are dealing with temporarily, any information they want to keep regarding temporary staff, things to do list, etc.

Records of the preschool programme should be open to inspection, by any officer authorised by the Government at any time.

7.2 Registers

There are different types of registers maintained in a preschool, such as, stock register, accounts register, teacher attendance register, children's attendance register, etc. Teachers need to have familiarity about maintaining these.

Teachers' attendance register

It is important to keep a record of teacher's attendance in school. The teacher needs to sign daily in the attendance register and record the time of coming in and leaving the preschool. This is important for maintaining discipline (both punctuality and regularity), keeping accounts (salary), etc. Entries must be made in ink and blanks should not be left. If possible, the online biometric teacher's attendance system should be maintained in all the States and UTs.

Children's attendance register

It is very important to keep the attendance record of children. A bound record or register is better for keeping the record intact. The reasons for absenteeism should be mentioned in the register.

Staff profile register or service book

This register having staff profile called as 'service book', needs to be maintained in the preschools. It contains the details of teachers such as name, educational qualifications, experience, residential address, telephone numbers, e-mail ID, brief account of family members and their telephone numbers. The record needs to be updated with information, such as, responsibilities handled by the teacher, deputation for the courses (if any), seminars, workshops attended by them, achievements during service, medical problems faced (if any), applied for special leave any time during the service, loan received from the office (if any), etc.

Accounts register

It includes the details of fee collection, expenditure on purchase of some item for the preschool, amount spent on supplementary food provided to children, amount spent on washing of clothes like hand towels, curtains, table cloth, bedsheets, rent of costumes used for some function, etc. It should be regularly checked by the headmistress or principal and the administrator.

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Stock register

For every preschool, a general stock register is necessary. It must contain a detailed list of all the articles and other items, such as accessories, toys, equipment, furniture, etc.

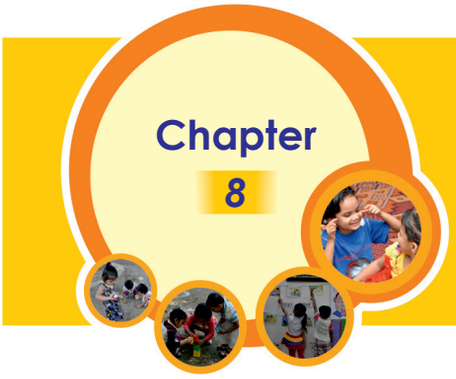
7.3 Preschool Calendar

The preschool may plan and develop a preschool calendar where probable dates of various upcoming events and activities of the year must be mentioned. It should be developed at the beginning of the academic session. Following are the suggestive content:

- Information about general, local and gazetted holidays.
- Dates for Parent Teacher Meetings (PTMs).
- Dates for field trips, excursions, sports, cultural events, etc.
- Dates for ECCE day, annual day, etc.

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Chapter 8

Coordination and Convergence

Young children have multiple needs like health, nutrition, protection, and education which need to be fulfilled for optimal growth and development. An effective delivery of early childhood service requires convergence of goals and a shared understanding of holistic child development by different sectors like health, education, and social protection. There should be vertical convergence between all stakeholders, such as, policy planners, administrators, implementers, providers, parents and community and also horizontal convergence between different ministries, departments and sections within departments, dealing with different components of medical, health, care and early education. For insuring quality preschool programme, developing coordination and convergence is important for different functions.

8.1 Administrative

- It includes setting up an appropriate coordination and convergence system for planning, management and review of quality and progress of implementation of the preschool programme at National and State level. All concerned ministries like MHRD, MWCD, Health, Water, Urban Development and *Panchayati Raj* should be a part of it.
- Appropriate planning and timely allocation of financial resources for the programme implementation like manpower, infrastructure and teaching-learning material at national, state and district level should be ensured.
- Regular inter-departmental meetings should be held at the state, district, and block level between school education officials and the ICDS functionaries for coming out with action points to bring about improvement at the grass root level.
- A group of resource agencies like NCTE, NCERT, NIPCCD, SCERT, DIET, Universities, NGOs and Private Sector, Technical Partners, etc., having technical expertise and experience in early education should be created for providing support, developing curriculum for children as well as for teacher training programmes, conducting research and preparing resource material.
- ECCE Council at National and State level as outlined in National Policy on ECCE should be formulated.
- Preschools and primary schools should be located in same premises or in close proximity. There should be synchronisation of the timings of the preschool with that of the primary schools.
- Principal or headmaster of primary school should be made responsible for preschool education component.
- One of the existing primary school teachers should be designated as Incharge of preschool education for developing strong linkages, ensuring quality and smooth transitions.

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- There should be sharing of resources, joint conduct of activities like annual day, sports day, assembly, etc., between preschools and primary schools.

8.2 Training and Capacity-building

- Orientation and capacity-building programmes for all officials, and the members of elected bodies and various civil society bodies should be conducted on the importance of preschool education.
- Joint efforts should be made for training of preschool teachers, *anganwadi* workers, primary teachers and health workers for understanding links between learning and development of children at preschool and primary stage.
- Responsibilities should be shared by ministry and different resource agencies with the MWCD, MHRD, NCERT, SCERT, DIET, MLTC, AWTC, NIPCCD for capacity-building and implementation of preschool programme.
- Onsite academic support should be provided by the CRC, BRC, CDPOs, Supervisors, etc.
- Infrastructure of SCERTs, DIETs, BRCs, MLTCs, AWTCs and CRCs should be used for the training of preschool teachers, *anganwadi* workers and other related functionaries.

8.3 Monitoring and Supervision

- There should be joint monitoring and supervision of preschool classroom processes and practices.
- The headmistress or headmaster should provide on the spot guidance to the teachers.
- The headmistress or headmaster should observe the safety and quality of education.
- No child should be left unsupervised within the preschool premises.
- The teachers and helpers should supervise the children's play in their interest areas.
- Parents of preschool children should also be the members of School Management Committee (SMC). The SMC members of the school should look after and provide support in the smooth functioning of preschool programme.
- Preschool inspectors, zonal or *mandal* level education officers, district education officers and state education officers need to visit the preschool premises regularly and observe the quality of preschool activities. The officers should understand the objective of the preschool education programme.
- The preschool inspector should visit the preschool centres more frequently and report to the zonal education officer.
- The zonal education officer should visit the preschools at least once in three months and report to the district education officer. Visits should be meaningful and they should spend adequate time in each preschool. During visits, the teachers should be oriented or made aware of the recent developments in preschool education.

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Annexure I

List of Suggestive Play Materials and Equipment

Domains	Materials and Equipment
Physical and Motor Development	**Gross Motor Skill** Large size blocks, wheel toys, climbers, tyres, balls of different sizes, balance beams, ladders, jungle gyms, tyre structures, tunnels, slides, swings, sea-saws, hanging bars, pushing and pulling toys, tri-cycles, toy cars, trucks, airplanes, bean bags, hula hoops, ropes, balance planks.
	Fine Motor Skill Button frames, shoes for lacing, beads for stringing, building blocks, puzzles, fastening frames, locking devices, interlocking blocks, lego blocks, zipping frames, sewing cards, geoboard, foam blocks, sieves, blunt scissors, weaving cards, hammering toys, sand tools, hollow blocks, sewing cards, spools to string, eye-dropper and funnel.
Social and Emotional Development	Activity prop boxes, including materials related to the child's experience such as doctor's kit, house-keeping materials, toy telephones, grocery items, puppets and puppet stage, toy money, pictures of helpers, dolls, doll house, name puzzles, name cards, dress-me dolls, musical instruments, discarded telephones, old cameras, etc.
Cognitive Development	Sensory material (feely bag, touch cards, texture books, etc.) magnifying glass, dominoes, different shapes, colour cards, matching games, building block props (stop sign, toy trucks, etc.), manipulative materials (puzzles, material for one-to-one correspondence, bingo-type games, colour lotto, seriated shapes, pink tower (Montessori), peg boards, nuts and screws, inset boards, geoboard, colour dominoes, shape dominoes, number dominoes, stacking and nesting toys, counting books, set of objects for ordering (shortest to tallest, biggest to smallest, number rods, abacus, take apart toys), pan-balance, texture numerals, leaves, stones, pebbles, twigs, flowers, picture cards, water-play toys, and mirrors. • Collections of real objects for sorting and counting: buttons, shells, keys, pebbles, seeds and nuts. • Play money, balance scales, counting books, pre-number concept books, sound jars, smelling jars, magnets, funnels, locks and keys, seeds, small containers and potting soil. • Sequential thinking cards, reasoning cards and other such material that allow a child to reflect on, act on and learn from.
Creative Development	Varied kind of paints, varied sizes and textures of paper, sketch pens, markers, clay (plasticine, potter's clay and home-made dough), mixing bowls, glue, cloth or fabric pieces, weaving frames, blunt scissors, thick crayons, brushes with long handles, yarn or wool, rolling pins and cooking cutters, coloured chalks, sponges, paper plates, water colours, nuts and bolts, plastic squeeze bottles, egg cartons, easels, open shelves, rhythmic instruments (cymbals, rhythm sticks, bells, xylophone) for music and movement activities, materials for making print (fork, rolling pin, spools, vegetables, blocks), dress up clothes, straws, wood scraps, and any such other materials that children can use to represent their world.

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Language and Literacy Development	**Reading-readiness Material** Concept books, picture books, chalk board, wordless picture books on familiar subjects, story books, information books, puppets, finger puppets, dress-up clothes, CDs and DVDs of stories and rhymes, language games, picture charts for language experience, textured letters, picture dominoes, letter-picture domino, letter-picture puzzles, puzzles of story characters, story cards, finger plays, reading-readiness material—picture lotto games that have pictures labeled with words, picture dictionary, name puzzles, road and traffic signs, manipulative alphabet material, old typewriter, computer, conversation charts on different topics, pictures of all kinds of objects, plants, animals and people, rhyming sound cards, alphabet board, flannel board with cutouts of characters, alphabet books, and teacher and childmade books.
	Writing-readiness Material Magic slates, running blackboards or chalkboards, chalks, sand trays, writing templates, name cards, alphabet chart pasted on the wall in literacy area, bulletin board to display samples of children's writing, variety of white and coloured paper, thick crayons, thick pencils, erasers, alphabet letter print set and stamp pad, rug, storage and display rack for books, and discarded rubber stamps.

Note: Teachers should be encouraged to use locally available, low cost and no cost, teacher made, contextualised material and toys which are easily available.

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Annexure II

Sample for Maintaining Emergency Contact Details

S. No.	Name of the Child	Mother's Name	Date of Birth	Father's Name	Contact Number	Emergency Contact Name	Emergency Contact Number	Allergy/ Medication	Doctor's Name	Doctor's Contact Number

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Hello Children!

If you feel uneasy about someone touching you inappropriately, you should not keep quiet. You must

1. Not blame yourself
2. Tell someone whom you trust
3. You can also inform National Commission for Protection of Child Rights through the **POCSO e-box**.

When you get an unsafe touch, you may feel bad, confused and helpless
You need not feel "bad" because it's not your fault



POCSO e-box available at NCPCR@gov.in

नए समाज की ओर
Towards a new dawn

If you are below 18 years of age, and are troubled or confused or abused or in distress or know some other child who is...

*Call **1098**...because some numbers are good!*
They change lives!!!



CHILDLINE 1098 - a national 24 hours toll free emergency phone service for children in distress is an initiative of CHILDLINE India Foundation supported by Ministry of Women & Child Development

नए समाज की ओर
Towards a new dawn

Swachh Bharat
Ek Kadam Swachchhta ki or

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